within Sunni Islam. According to Juzjani, Isma'ili communities remained in Multan until Mu'izz al-Din's campaign there in AH 571/1175–1176 CE, when their presence finally came to an end (see also above).

After taking Multan and its vicinity from the last of the Isma'ilis, Mu'izz al-Din evidently re-inscribed the area within the domains of the Ghazna Shansabanis: he made substantial endowments to various institutions, including the incomes of two villages for defraying the overall operating costs of the city's *masjid-i jami'*, as well as further provisions for the mosque and its *mu'adhin*, and five salaried instructors for *madrasa*s. While it is possible that Mu'izz al-Din constructed a mosque and/or *madrasa*s to which he made these additional endowments, it seems more likely that such institutions – particularly the *masjid-i jami'* – would have already existed in a prosperous and important city like Multan, which also had a long Islamic affiliation. Mu'izz al-Din's endowments, moreover, remained in place at least for the following two centuries, being recorded in the surviving correspondence of the mid-fourteenth century by the Tughluq-deputed governor of the city.[18]

Thus, the Shansabani sultan of Ghazna made a substantial mark on Multan and possibly also Lahore, even without patronizing new and monumental architecture but rather by appropriating their important institutions *via* endowments intended to exist in perpetuity, re-inscribing the cities as having entered within Shansabani domains. It is precisely the "blended-in" quality of Shansabani architectural traces that provides strong continuity with their discretely adaptive, region-specific modes of gaining control of the physical and cultural environments that they encountered during the early decades of their ascendancy, both in their homeland of Ghur and beyond.[19]

The clustering of surviving Shansabani-period sites along the middle Indus – traversed by the northeast–southwest corridors spanning the historically significant cities of Multan and Lahore and reaching beyond into Baluchistan (discussed subsequently in this chapter) – is certainly convenient for scholarly analysis. But an *exclusive* focus on these architectural traces would not elucidate the architectural and cultural geographies the Ghazna Shansabanis encountered on their other campaigns, for example, the northeastward foray to Peshawar and historical Gandhara and Swat in AH 575/1179–1180 CE, or the southeasterly push into Sindh in AH 578/1182 CE (cf. further below). Built remains of Shansabani presence in these regions may yet come to light; but even without securely identified traces of their successful campaigns there, we can reasonably suppose that the Shansabanis marked or otherwise re-inscribed their conquered tracts, which were most often commercially and strategically important urban centers and their associated environs. Preceding a concentrated treatment of the Shansabani-period tombs within the Indus-dependent areas, a brief excursion into Gandhara–Swat and Sindh–Baluchistan–Makran helps